Weekly job efficiency review

Tuesday, November 10, 2026 — first review. Proposals only. Nothing was changed by this review; every change waits on Clay's word.

The whole story, page 1

- **One day of record, not seven.** The effort log started on 2026-11-10, so this first review rests on that one full day. Next week's review will have the full seven days.
- **The day's totals:** 287 runs, 453 minutes of agent work, 192,735,155 tokens. Token counts are the size of the work, not an exact price.
- **Four watch jobs took 216 of the 287 runs and 121,658,657 tokens — about 63 of every 100 tokens spent that day.** They watch for work instead of doing work Clay reads.
- **The biggest one is already fixed.** The old open work watch ran every 5 minutes: 113 runs and 68,316,571 tokens in one day. On 2026-11-10 it was replaced by a safety check every 6 hours plus a plain script that wakes an agent only when the open work list itself changes.

The five heaviest jobs that day

1. **Open work watch (checks every 5 minutes)** — 113 runs, 106.9 minutes, 68,316,571 tokens
2. **Community report idle watch** — 56 runs, 59.5 minutes, 24,066,182 tokens
3. **Production review idle watch** — 28 runs, 34.7 minutes, 15,002,089 tokens
4. **Stalled run watch** — 19 runs, 34.9 minutes, 14,273,815 tokens
5. **My Daily Review** — 1 runs, 17.9 minutes, 7,103,800 tokens

Suspected waste, with the saving each fix would bring

- **Community report idle watch** — 56 runs, 24,066,182 tokens in one day, checking every 10 minutes whether it may start. A plain-script change hook, the same road the open work watch just took, would cut nearly all of it: about **23 million tokens a day**.
- **Production review idle watch** — 28 runs, 15,002,089 tokens, checking every 20 minutes. Same hook road: about **14 million tokens a day**.
- **Stalled run watch** — 19 runs, 14,273,815 tokens, checking every 30 minutes for runs that stopped moving. That check reads times and states — a plain script can do it with no agent at all: about **13 million tokens a day**.
- **GitHub letter watch** — 5 runs, 3,917,310 tokens, checking every 2 hours for a failure letter. Letters already arrive in the Muse Mail box; an arrival check by script would cut most of it: about **3 million tokens a day**.

- **Yard and estate sales, two jobs** — refresh plus recheck cost 7,699,246 tokens in one day for one sheet. Checking only the sources that changed would cut roughly **3 million tokens a day**.

Stale list

- **Grow light delivery check** — one-time job set for October 12, 2026, now switched off. The date has passed. PROPOSAL: remove it.
- **Hourly status update** — switched off, replaced by the Morning Menu as the one standing delivery. PROPOSAL: remove it.
- **Story player button set** — one-time job that ran and finished on 2026-11-10. Nothing left standing.
- **Failed jobs proof watch** — a proof job: it records each job's next real run. Once the proofs are in, it has nothing left to prove. Cutting candidate after the proofs finish.

Jobs whose output reached Clay that day, through the Morning Menu or a page he reads: the Morning Menu itself, My Daily Review, the AI community report, the Steward's Ledger, the morning agenda briefing, and the yard and estate sales sheet. Jobs whose output nobody sees directly are the watches above — they earn their keep only when they catch something, and three of them can catch it with a script instead of an agent.

One line per job — the day's effort record

Schedule notes: idle watches run every 10, 20, or 30 minutes; the letter watch every 2 hours; most other rows run once a day; the weekly jobs run Tuesday night. Jobs with no agent work (heartbeat pulse, the deterministic doctor, the Feed pulses) cost no tokens and are listed under the table.

Job	Runs	Minutes	Tokens	Verdict
Open work watch (checks every 5 minutes)	113	106.9	68,316,571	Cheaper road already taken — the 5-minute agent watch was replaced on 2026-11-10 by a 6-hour safety check plus a plain-script change hook. Verify next week that the saving holds.
Community report idle watch	56	59.5	24,066,182	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 1
Production review idle watch	28	34.7	15,002,089	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 2
Stalled run watch	19	34.9	14,273,815	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 3
My Daily Review	1	17.9	7,103,800	Keep — read every morning. Cheaper road to test: PROPOSAL 8
AI community report	2	30.0	6,974,198	Keep — the report Clay reads. Two runs a night is the build plus its finish run.
Story player button set	1	21.8	6,096,554	Stale — one-time job, done on 2026-11-10. Nothing left to run.

Gilded Pages healthcare rollout	1	18.2	5,110,233	Keep for now — a rollout with an end. Name its finish date next week or it becomes a cutting candidate.
Yard and estate sales refresh	1	16.6	4,734,551	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 7 (with its recheck)
GitHub letter watch	5	9.4	3,917,310	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 4
Steward's Ledger daily	1	7.3	3,740,006	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Morning jobs finished check	1	6.2	3,595,417	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Morning agenda briefing	1	8.3	3,166,897	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
AI stories podcast nightly	1	8.7	2,976,634	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Escrow daily update	1	16.9	2,975,800	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Yard and estate sales recheck	1	8.6	2,972,213	Cheaper road exists — PROPOSAL 7 (with its refresh)
GitHub billing watch	1	9.2	2,909,248	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Morning menu	1	7.2	2,677,911	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Maker finds watch	1	4.3	2,011,476	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Daily walk watch	1	6.0	1,559,405	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
GitHub production cleanup	1	4.2	1,274,958	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Feed switches daily sync	1	1.9	1,082,753	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Connectors report	1	2.3	1,045,653	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Family photo access count	1	0.8	914,501	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Nightly orphan check	1	1.6	913,327	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Health sync watch	2	2.3	883,602	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Report notes nightly purge	1	1.1	621,832	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
GitHub traffic count	1	2.5	573,677	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.

Stale work check (morning)	1	1.5	512,235	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Muse credit watch	1	0.9	403,253	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Failed jobs proof watch	1	0.9	329,054	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Heartbeat	19	0.0	0	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Deterministic doctor	10	0.0	0	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.
Feed pulses (9 small checks)	9	0.3	0	Keep — output feeds the Morning Menu, a page Clay reads, or a standing watch he asked for.

Also standing, with no token cost that day: Heartbeat (19 runs, a plain pulse), Deterministic doctor (10 runs, no agent), Feed pulses (9 checks, no agent), plus the rest of the saved job list — about 96 schedules in all, counting the 24 hourly Feed pulses and the system jobs. One-time jobs still to come and not stale: the Black Friday checks (November 22–29), the coffee maker deal check (November 23), the filament checks (November 11 and 17), the Google One final check (December 1), and the first Scroll recording roll-off check (December 11). Weekly jobs that ran Tuesday night — the 18650 battery check, the 149 gates revisit, the tools and systems check, and the connectors weekly review — are counted in the nightly effort record and will show in full in next week's seven-day sums.

Proposals — every change suggested, each waiting on Clay's word

1. **PROPOSAL 1:** Move the Community report idle watch from a 10-minute agent check to a plain-script change hook, the road the open work watch took on 2026-11-10. Saving: about 23 million tokens a day.
2. **PROPOSAL 2:** Move the Production review idle watch from a 20-minute agent check to the same kind of script hook. Saving: about 14 million tokens a day.
3. **PROPOSAL 3:** Move the Stalled run watch to a plain script that reads run times and states and wakes an agent only when a run is truly stalled. Saving: about 13 million tokens a day.
4. **PROPOSAL 4:** Move the GitHub letter watch to a script check of the Muse Mail box on arrival, keeping the rule that a real GitHub letter is read, acted on, and reported at once. Saving: about 3 million tokens a day.
5. **PROPOSAL 5:** Check next week that the new open work safety check (every 6 hours) plus its change hook held the saving — the old road cost 68 million tokens in its last full day.
6. **PROPOSAL 6:** Remove the two switched-off stale jobs: the grow light delivery check (date passed, October 12) and the hourly status update (replaced by the Morning Menu).
7. **PROPOSAL 7:** Join the yard and estate sales refresh and recheck into one pass that re-reads only sources that changed. Saving: about 3 million tokens a day.

8. **PROPOSAL 8:** Test a stored-table road for My Daily Review — store the standing facts it re-reads each night and read them back — and report the saving before any switch. Its one run cost 7,103,800 tokens.
9. **PROPOSAL 9:** Cut the stale-work check from three runs a day to one. Small saving — about 0.3 million tokens a day — and two fewer runs crowding the morning.
10. **PROPOSAL 10:** Give the Gilded Pages healthcare rollout a named finish date in its own notes. A rollout that never ends becomes a daily cost with no end: 5,110,233 tokens for its one run that day.

This review changed nothing: it connected nothing, edited no job, slowed nothing, and stopped nothing. Sources: the effort record at ~/workspace/effort-log/effort-data.csv (one day, 2026-11-10 — the log's first day), the saved job list from cron.list including switched-off jobs, and the run record for the heavy watches, which finished clean all evening and started the next piece of work only rarely.